UPSC CSAT Paper II — Hard Simulation 5

Date: 2026-10-04 | Maximum Marks: 200 | Time: 120 minutes

Topics: Comprehension | Numeracy & DI | Logical/Analytical Ability | Decision-making

INSTRUCTIONS:

- 80 objective questions; each carries 2.5 marks. Maximum marks: 200.
- Time allowed: 120 minutes. Qualifying benchmark: 33% of 200 under the notified scheme; verify the current notification.
- Negative marking: one-third of the marks assigned to a question for a wrong answer; blank answers carry no penalty.
- This question paper is answer-free. Use the separately supplied answer key and solutions only after submission.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 1 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 1. Discussions of school learning recovery often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q1. Passage 1 is principally arguing that: Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q2. Passage 1 most clearly permits which inference? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q3. The reasoning in Passage 1 depends on which assumption? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q4. Which description most accurately characterises the tone of Passage 1? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 2 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 2. Discussions of last-mile public health often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q5. Which interpretation most accurately states the main proposition of Passage 2? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q6. Which conclusion follows most securely from Passage 2? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q7. Which presupposition is required by the argument in Passage 2? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q8. Passage 2 adopts which overall rhetorical posture? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 3 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 3. Discussions of transport planning and accessibility often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q9. The central contention developed in Passage 3 is that: Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q10. Reading Passage 3 closely, which inference is justified? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q11. Passage 3 would be weakened most directly if which assumption failed? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q12. The authorial stance in Passage 3 is: Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 4 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 4. Discussions of climate adaptation finance often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q13. With reference to Passage 4, which one of the following best captures its central claim? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q14. Which one of the following is most directly inferable from Passage 4? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q15. Which one of the following assumptions is necessary for the argument in Passage 4? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q16. The tone of Passage 4 is best described as: Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 5 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 5. Discussions of institutional trust in a digital age often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q17. Passage 5 is principally arguing that: Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q18. Passage 5 most clearly permits which inference? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q19. The reasoning in Passage 5 depends on which assumption? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q20. Which description most accurately characterises the tone of Passage 5? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION B — NUMERACY AND DATA INTERPRETATION (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q21. If r is the remainder when 3^19 + 4^17 is divided by 18, what is r? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q22. How many integers from 1 through 106, inclusive, are divisible by 7 or 13, but not by both? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q23. Solution A contains 25% solute and solution B contains 17% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 6:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q24. Three independent teams complete a task in 17, 22 and 36 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q25. The average score of 24 candidates is 57. One score of 48 is replaced by 81. What is the new average? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q26. A quantity rises by 14%, falls by 22%, and then rises by 20%. What is the net percentage change? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q27. A rectangle of dimensions 17 m by 15 m has squares of side 4 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q28. A five-period index has values [3, 5, 7, 9, 11]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q29. How many multiples of lcm(8, 10) lie in the inclusive interval [43, 167]? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q30. A sequence begins [2, 9, 11, 18]. Its successive increments are 7, 2, 7, 2, ... What is the next term? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q31. If r is the remainder when 3^20 + 4^18 is divided by 12, what is r? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q32. How many integers from 3 through 96, inclusive, are divisible by 10 or 14, but not by both? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q33. Solution A contains 20% solute and solution B contains 14% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 8:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q34. Three independent teams complete a task in 18, 21 and 33 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q35. The average score of 25 candidates is 56. One score of 45 is replaced by 74. What is the new average? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q36. A quantity rises by 16%, falls by 23%, and then rises by 20%. What is the net percentage change? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q37. A rectangle of dimensions 19 m by 13 m has squares of side 2 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q38. A five-period index has values [4, 6, 8, 10, 3]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q39. How many multiples of lcm(12, 13) lie in the inclusive interval [159, 631]? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q40. A sequence begins [4, 11, 15, 22]. Its successive increments are 7, 4, 7, 4, ... What is the next term? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION C — LOGICAL REASONING AND ANALYTICAL ABILITY (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q41. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q42. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q43. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 6, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q44. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 6 members are in X, 8 additional members are in Y but not X, and 8 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q45. A field worker moves 4 km east and then 8 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q46. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q47. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q48. From 9 proposals, 4 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q49. A team records 6 wins, 4 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q50. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 9 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q51. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q52. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q53. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 4, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q54. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 4 members are in X, 8 additional members are in Y but not X, and 6 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q55. A field worker moves 8 km east and then 8 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q56. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q57. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q58. From 9 proposals, 5 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q59. A team records 4 wins, 2 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q60. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 9 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION D — DECISION-MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q61. In an industrial cluster, a file concerning worker-safety inspections is being reviewed by factory inspectors; the available evidence includes incident and audit reports. A pilot produces mixed results across neighbourhoods. How should the administrator respond? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q62. In an industrial cluster, a file concerning worker-safety inspections is being reviewed by factory inspectors; the available evidence includes incident and audit reports. A grievance channel receives fewer complaints after a redesign. What is the most careful interpretation? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q63. In an industrial cluster, a file concerning worker-safety inspections is being reviewed by factory inspectors; the available evidence includes incident and audit reports. A contractor asks to relax a safety condition to meet a deadline. What should the officer do? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q64. In an industrial cluster, a file concerning worker-safety inspections is being reviewed by factory inspectors; the available evidence includes incident and audit reports. A beneficiary list contains duplicate names and some genuine exclusions. What is the right sequence? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q65. In an industrial cluster, a file concerning worker-safety inspections is being reviewed by factory inspectors; the available evidence includes incident and audit reports. A local leader requests an exception for one influential applicant. What is defensible? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q66. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A new digital process excludes some intended users. What should the officer do first? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q67. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. Two agencies submit conflicting records before a time-sensitive public intervention. What is the soundest next step? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q68. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A service reports high activity, but users say their underlying problems remain unresolved. Which measure should follow? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q69. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A fund can support a visible ceremony or a tested low-cost intervention. Which decision is stronger? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q70. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A lowest bid has a minor clerical error but no evidence of material advantage. What is fairest? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q71. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A measurement conflicts with credible user reports before a sanction is proposed. What should precede action? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q72. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A public message must announce an uncertain hazard. Which communication is most responsible? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q73. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. Scarce services must be allocated between a larger population and a higher untreated-need rate. What rule is soundest? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q74. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A performance target encourages staff to close cases without resolving them. What correction is best? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q75. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A vocal association claims to represent everyone, but consultation attendance is narrow. What should follow? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q76. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A pilot produces mixed results across neighbourhoods. How should the administrator respond? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q77. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A grievance channel receives fewer complaints after a redesign. What is the most careful interpretation? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q78. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A contractor asks to relax a safety condition to meet a deadline. What should the officer do? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q79. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A beneficiary list contains duplicate names and some genuine exclusions. What is the right sequence? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q80. In a forest fringe, a file concerning human-wildlife response is being reviewed by range officers; the available evidence includes callout and response records. A local leader requests an exception for one influential applicant. What is defensible? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

Total: 200 Marks | UPSC Practice Paper | Copilot CLI UPSC Agent